

CFO departure likely to weigh

Conclusion

STAN has announced that CFO Diego De Giorgi has left with immediate effect and is to be replaced with internal appointee Peter Burrill (who, until today, served as deputy CFO) on an interim basis. Mr De Giorgi is leaving for Apollo. Whilst banks are ultimately run by many more people than the key C-suite members, this departure is a particular blow for STAN in our view.

Thus, Mr De Giorgi had been not only the driving force behind the 'Fit For Growth' efficiency program, but also had a transformational effect on investor communications over the past several years, contributing not just to financial performance but also better communications which have helped the share price multiple. Further, many investors and market participants regarded Mr De Giorgi as a contender for the CEO job at some point.

The timing of the move is unhelpful with FY results 23 Feb and a medium-term strategy update to be provided in Hong Kong in May, which we regard as a very important event.

FIRST VIEW

RATING	BUY
PRICE	1,899.00p [*]
PRICE TARGET % TO PT	1,640.00p -14%
52W HIGH-LOW	1,924p - 873p
FLOAT (%) ADV MM (USD)	74.9% 98.40
MARKET CAP	£45.3B \$61.9B
TICKER	STAN LN

^{*}Prior trading day's closing price unless otherwise noted.

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Standard Chartered PLC

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Standard Chartered PLC

We value STAN using a Gordon Growth methodology and apply a 12% Ke & 2% growth rate to our ests. Risks to our positive stance include a meaningful deterioration in revenues or drastic deterioration in the credit backdrop.

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Investment Recommendation Record

(Article 3(1)e and Article 7 of MAR)

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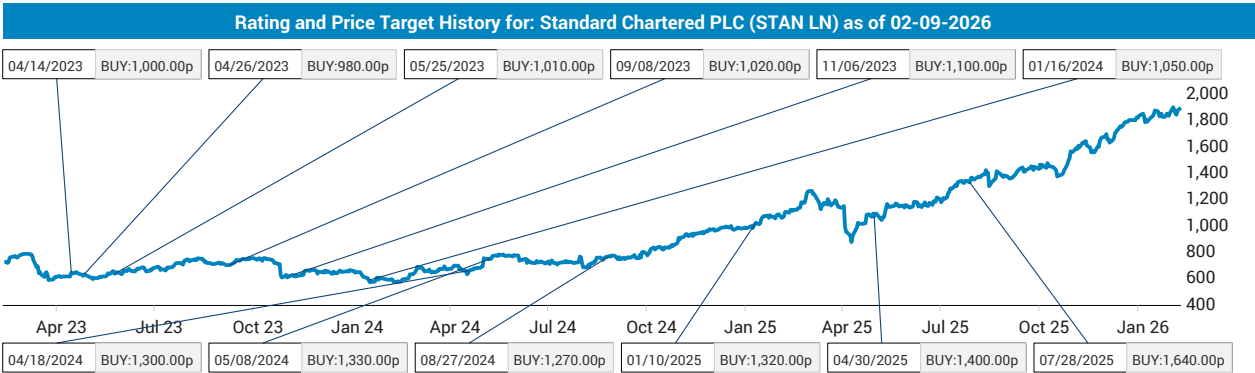
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Other Companies Mentioned in This Report

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- UP: Underperform

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